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1. CPU socket

There are two main manufacturers for desktop processors - Intel and AMD. Each have hundreds of processors up for sale. Every six months or so either manufacturer will release 6-20 new processors. Intel follows a certain pattern called the Tick-Tock cycle where the Ticks and Tocks refer to changes in the processor architecture or manufacturing process. Earlier the Tick and Tocks were years apart. Now they happen every 8-12 months. AMD has a similar product cycle where it comes up with a new architecture and after that improves upon the same architecture for a year or so.

So every six-months we have a lot of new processors entering the market and every year or so the socket pin count changes. Sometimes it is all for just 1 pin like the LGA 1156 and the LGA 1155 which are differentiated by just one pin. The wiring of the pin does change internally so don't go about putting a LGA 1155 processor onto a LGA 1156 socket. Basically Intel will have three sockets which distinguish the type of processors that the motherboard supports. There is the entry level socket, mid-range and then comes the enthusiast level. AMD on the other hand has been keen on using the same socket for a couple of generations. Maybe it has more to do with how far apart the iterations in their product life cycle are. So in the long term getting an AMD motherboard would ensure that you could upgrade your processor though a few architecture revisions while an Intel based board would be best for just about 2 years.

Current sockets are by design either LGA (Land Grid Array) or ZIF (Zero Insertion Force) sockets. LGA sockets have an array of bent metal pins in the socket which makes contact with the pads underneath a processor, this way the processor is more durable because of their pinless design. ZIF sockets